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Dear Editors,

Please consider our research article, “Classifier selection, score estimation and event coverage in inertial pavement screening”, for the *International Journal of Pavement Engineering*. The paper addresses evaluation of low-cost sensor-based road-surface screening, with a focus on selecting classifiers for new acquisition conditions and communicating their expected performance.

The study separates three outcomes of inertial pavement screening: selecting a classifier, estimating its outer performance and covering annotated events at an assessed alarm cost. Fixed-candidate PVS comparisons show that selected-model F1 can improve while estimation error increases. A separately collected Karlsruhe final-date test, with spatial purging and matched inner training budgets, improves classification and estimation while both selected systems detect seven of 12 pothole intervals. RoadSens temporal controls provide consistent positive classification gains, and full supporting experiments are retained in the supplement.

The connection to pavement engineering is the evaluation evidence supporting a screening model’s use across survey conditions. The article relates acquisition grouping and label semantics to the distinction between pavement distress, intentional road features and non-event observations, and quantifies the resulting interval coverage and notification burden. It complements work on smartphone-based pavement measurement by examining classification-based screening and the accuracy of validation estimates.

The submission materials include an anonymous manuscript, separate author details, supplementary results, editable tables and vector figures. Code, protocols and compact results are publicly available. The study received no specific funding, and the authors report no competing interests.

Thank you for considering this manuscript.

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